



HOW TO PLAY

remember when

Start Here: Leading a Reminiscence Activity



Who this is for

Caregivers, activity directors, and families spending time with an older adult. Every activity is low prep, needs only the printout and a warm voice, and works one on one or with a small group.

How to lead it

Read slowly and give plenty of time to answer. There are no wrong answers in the conversation activities, only stories worth hearing. For the quizzes, offer gentle hints and celebrate every try. Keep sessions to twenty or thirty minutes.

A gentle note

Follow the person's lead. If a memory brings joy, linger there. If a topic feels heavy, move to the next card. The goal is connection and a good moment together, not a perfect score.





QUIZ

remember when

Finish the Familiar Saying

Read the first half of each well known saying out loud and let the group call out the ending. Say the answer together and share what the saying means to you. Answers are on the leader key.

1. A penny saved is a penny...

.....

2. The early bird catches the...

.....

3. An apple a day keeps the doctor...

.....

4. Better late than...

.....

5. A stitch in time saves...

.....

6. When the going gets tough, the tough get...

.....

7. You cannot judge a book by its...

.....

8. Too many cooks spoil the...

.....

9. A picture is worth a thousand...

.....

10. Actions speak louder than...

.....

11. The grass is always greener on the other side of the...

.....

12. Do not count your chickens before they...

.....

13. Birds of a feather flock...

.....

14. Every cloud has a silver...

.....





ANSWER KEY

remember when

Finish the Familiar Saying: Leader's Answers

Leader: fill this out before the party. This is the official answer key.

1. A penny saved is a penny...

.....

2. The early bird catches the...

.....

3. An apple a day keeps the doctor...

.....

4. Better late than...

.....

5. A stitch in time saves...

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6. When the going gets tough, the tough
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13. Birds of a feather flock...

.....

14. Every cloud has a silver...

.....





HOW TO PLAY

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Finish the Familiar Saying: Leader Answer Key

Answers 1 to 7

1. Earned. 2. Worm. 3. Away. 4. Never. 5. Nine. 6. Going. 7. Cover.

Answers 8 to 14

8. Broth. 9. Words. 10. Words. 11. Fence. 12. Hatch. 13. Together. 14. Lining.





CONVERSATION

remember when

Remember When: Growing Up

Read one prompt at a time and give the person plenty of room to answer. Follow the story wherever it goes. These are meant to open doors, not test memory.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Tell me about the house you grew up in | ☐ What was a special treat when you were little |
| ☐ What chores did you have as a child | ☐ Tell me about a holiday you loved as a child |
| ☐ What games did you play outside | ☐ What is something your grandparents taught you |
| ☐ Who was your best friend when you were young | ☐ What did you and your siblings get up to |
| ☐ What did your family do on a Sunday | ☐ What is a smell that takes you right back to childhood |
| ☐ What was your favorite meal your mother made | ☐ What was your favorite thing to do after school |
| ☐ Did you have a pet growing up | ☐ Tell me about a teacher you remember |
| ☐ What did you want to be when you grew up | ☐ What did your family do for fun with no money |
| ☐ What was your favorite subject in school | ☐ What is the first big news event you remember |
| ☐ How did you get to school each day | |
| ☐ What did you do on a hot summer day | |





CONVERSATION

remember when

Remember When: Work and Home

Continue the conversation with these prompts about the grown up years.
Let the person take the lead and enjoy the memories together.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ What was your very first job | ☐ Who was a boss or coworker you will never forget |
| ☐ How much was your first paycheck | ☐ What did you save up for and finally buy |
| ☐ Tell me about the work you did most of your life | ☐ What was a neighborhood or town you loved living in |
| ☐ How did you meet your husband or wife | ☐ What advice would you give a young person starting out |
| ☐ What was your first home together like | ☐ What is an accomplishment that still makes you proud |
| ☐ What was your favorite way to spend a weekend | ☐ What was your favorite home you ever lived in |
| ☐ What kind of car did you drive | ☐ Tell me about a wedding you will never forget |
| ☐ Where did you go on a special trip | ☐ What was your Sunday best outfit like |
| ☐ What did you cook for company | ☐ What is a tradition you kept in your own family |
| ☐ What did you do to relax after a long day | |
| ☐ What is a skill you are proud of learning | |





QUIZ

remember when Fact or Fiction

Read each statement out loud. The group decides together if it is fact or fiction, then you reveal the answer. A friendly, no pressure way to spark conversation and a few laughs.

1. Honey never spoils if it is stored properly. Fact or fiction?

2. A group of crows is called a murder. Fact or fiction?

3. Carrots help you see in the dark. Fact or fiction?

4. The Great Wall of China is visible from the moon with the naked eye. Fact or fiction?

5. Bananas grow on trees. Fact or fiction?

6. A goldfish has a memory of only three seconds. Fact or fiction?

7. Lightning never strikes the same place twice. Fact or fiction?

8. An ostrich buries its head in the sand when scared. Fact or fiction?

9. The average person swallows several spiders a year in their sleep. Fact or fiction?

10. Cracking your knuckles causes arthritis. Fact or fiction?

11. A tomato is technically a fruit. Fact or fiction?

12. Chameleons change color mainly to match their background. Fact or fiction?





ANSWER KEY

remember when

Fact or Fiction: Leader's Answers

Leader: fill this out before the party. This is the official answer key.

1. Honey never spoils if it is stored properly. Fact or fiction?

2. A group of crows is called a murder. Fact or fiction?

3. Carrots help you see in the dark. Fact or fiction?

4. The Great Wall of China is visible from the moon with the naked eye. Fact or fiction?

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12. Chameleons change color mainly to match their background. Fact or fiction?





HOW TO PLAY

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Fact or Fiction: Leader Answer Key

Answers 1 to 6

1. Fact. 2. Fact. 3. Fiction, a myth from wartime. 4. Fiction. 5. Fiction, bananas grow on a large plant, not a tree. 6. Fiction, their memory lasts months.

Answers 7 to 12

7. Fiction, it can strike twice. 8. Fiction, they lower their heads to the ground. 9. Fiction, a common myth. 10. Fiction. 11. Fact. 12. Fiction, mainly for temperature and mood.





THIS OR THAT

remember when

The Way Things Were: This or That

Read each pair and ask which one the person prefers or remembers best.
There is no right answer. Each pair is a doorway to a story.

Handwritten letters *or* Telephone calls

Radio in the evening *or* Television in the evening

Home cooked dinner *or* Dinner out

Sunday drives *or* Sunday at home

The seaside *or* The countryside

Tea *or* Coffee

Dancing *or* Watching the dancing

A good book *or* A good film

Summer *or* Winter

Cats *or* Dogs

City life *or* Small town life

Baking *or* Gardening

A big family gathering *or* A quiet evening in

Early riser *or* Night owl

Sweet treats *or* Savory snacks

Music from a band *or* Music from a singer





GROUP GAME

remember when

Name Something In This Category

Read a category and go around the group naming one thing that fits. Keep going until the group runs out. A gentle, cheerful way to keep minds active and voices in the room.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Name something you would find in a kitchen | ☐ Name something you would find in a garden |
| ☐ Name a type of flower | ☐ Name a musical instrument |
| ☐ Name something that is cold | ☐ Name something sweet |
| ☐ Name a farm animal | ☐ Name a mode of transport |
| ☐ Name a color | ☐ Name something you would pack for a picnic |
| ☐ Name something you wear on your feet | ☐ Name a job people do |
| ☐ Name a fruit | ☐ Name a bird |
| ☐ Name something you would take to the beach | ☐ Name something round |
| ☐ Name a tool you would find in a shed | ☐ Name a game children play |
| ☐ Name a kind of weather | ☐ Name something you would find at a fair |





QUIZ

remember when

Complete the Pair

These go together like an old married couple. Read the first word and let the group fill in the partner. Warm, easy, and always good for a smile.
Answers on the leader key.

1. Salt and...

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2. Bread and...

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3. Fish and...

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4. Bacon and...

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5. Knife and...

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6. Cup and...

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7. Needle and...

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8. Shoes and...

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9. Thunder and...

.....

10. Bread and... (a spread)

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11. Peaches and...

.....

12. Rock and...

.....

13. Sun and...

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14. Hugs and...

.....





ANSWER KEY

remember when

Complete the Pair: Leader's Answers

Leader: fill this out before the party. This is the official answer key.

1. Salt and...

.....

2. Bread and...

.....

3. Fish and...

.....

4. Bacon and...

.....

5. Knife and...

.....

6. Cup and...

.....

7. Needle and...

.....

8. Shoes and...

.....

9. Thunder and...

.....

10. Bread and... (a spread)

.....

11. Peaches and...

.....

12. Rock and...

.....

13. Sun and...

.....

14. Hugs and...

.....





HOW TO PLAY

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Complete the Pair: Leader Answer Key

Answers 1 to 7

1. Pepper. 2. Butter. 3. Chips. 4. Eggs. 5. Fork. 6. Saucer. 7. Thread.

Answers 8 to 14

8. Socks. 9. Lightning. 10. Jam. 11. Cream. 12. Roll. 13. Moon. 14. Kisses.
Accept any warm answer that fits.





remember when

My Life Story Keepsake Cards • Sheet 1 of 4

Write the person's answers on each card as they talk, or hand them the pen if they like. Keep the cards together as a small keepsake of their story to treasure and share with family.

advice & wishes

The full name I was given, and the story behind it

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.....

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.....

TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

Where and when I was born

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.....

TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

The people who raised me

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TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

A memory from my childhood I hold dear

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TOLD BY:





remember when

My Life Story Keepsake Cards • Sheet 2 of 4

Write the person's answers on each card as they talk, or hand them the pen if they like. Keep the cards together as a small keepsake of their story to treasure and share with family.

advice & wishes

The work I did and what I thought of it

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.....

.....

.....

.....

TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

How I met my sweetheart

.....

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TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

The proudest day of my life

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TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

A place that has always felt like home

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TOLD BY:





remember when

My Life Story Keepsake Cards • Sheet 3 of 4

Write the person's answers on each card as they talk, or hand them the pen if they like. Keep the cards together as a small keepsake of their story to treasure and share with family.

advice & wishes

A lesson life taught me the hard way

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.....

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TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

Something I have always been good at

.....

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.....

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TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

The people I love most in this world

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.....

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TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

A perfect ordinary day, from morning to night

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.....

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TOLD BY:





remember when

My Life Story Keepsake Cards • Sheet 4 of 4

Write the person's answers on each card as they talk, or hand them the pen if they like. Keep the cards together as a small keepsake of their story to treasure and share with family.

advice & wishes

Something that always makes me laugh

TOLD BY: _____

advice & wishes

A hope I have for the people I love

TOLD BY: _____

advice & wishes

Something I want to be remembered for

TOLD BY: _____

advice & wishes

A few words of advice for the next generation

TOLD BY: _____

